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The Court of Appeals in this case ignored unambiguous limitations on taxpayer and citizen standing. It appears to have done so out of the conviction that enforcement of the Establishment Clause demands special exceptions from the requirement that a plaintiff allege "‘distinct and palpable injury to himself,’ . . . that is likely to be redressed if the requested relief is granted." *Gladstone, Realtors v. Village of Bellwood*, 441 U. S., at 100 (quoting *Warth v. Seldin*, 422 U. S., at 501). The court derived precedential comfort from *Flast v. Cohen*: "The underlying justification for according standing in *Flast* it seems, was the implicit recognition that the Establishment Clause does create in every citizen a personal constitutional right, such that any citizen, including taxpayers, may contest under that clause the constitutionality of federal expenditures." 619 F. 2d, at 262.²⁵ The concurring opinion was even more direct. In its view, "statutes alleged to violate the Establishment Clause may not have an

agency action within the meaning of a relevant statute." Neither the Administrative Procedure Act, nor any other congressional enactment, can lower the threshold requirements of standing under Art. III. See, e. g., *Gladstone, Realtors v. Village of Bellwood*, 441 U. S., at 100; *Warth v. Seldin*, 422 U. S., at 501. Respondents do not allege that the Act creates a legal right, "the invasion of which creates standing," *Linda R. S. v. Richard D.*, 410 U. S., at 617, n. 3, and there is no other basis for arguing that its existence alters the rules of standing otherwise applicable to this case.

²⁵ The majority believed that the only thing which prevented this Court from openly acknowledging this position was the fact that the complaint in *Flast* had alleged no basis for standing other than the plaintiffs' taxpayer status. 619 F. 2d, at 262. As the dissent below pointed out, this view is simply not in accord with the facts. See *id.*, at 269-270. The *Flast* plaintiffs and several *amici* strongly urged the Court to adopt the same view of standing for which respondents argue in this case. The Court plainly chose not to do so. Even if respondents were correct in arguing that the Court in *Flast* was bound by a "perceived limitation in the pleadings," 619 F. 2d, at 262, we are not so bound in this case, and we find no merit in respondents' vision of standing.